

LEBANON

Lebanon: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Official Name	Lebanese Republic
Capital	Beirut
Region (UN)	Western European and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Parliamentary republic
President	Michel Aoun (as of 2025)
Prime Minister	Najib Mikati (as of 2025)
Currency	Lebanese pound (LBP)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945
Permanent UNSC Member	No
Key Issues	Refugee crisis, political instability, economic collapse, human rights

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Lebanon: A History, 600–2011	William Harris	Comprehensive historical overview
The Shi'is of Lebanon: Clans, Parties and Clerics	Fawwaz Traboulsi	Key for understanding sectarian politics
Inside the Middle East	Shimon Shamir	Regional politics with Lebanon context
Lebanon: The Politics of a Penetrated Society	Augustus Richard Norton	Political and social analysis

The War for Lebanon, 1970-1985	Itamar Rabinovich	Modern political history and conflicts
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Research Table: Lebanon & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Lebanese Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Emigrants – Human Rights	Lebanese MFA Human Rights	Official government portal outlining Lebanon's human rights policies and international commitments, foundational for official perspectives.
Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) – Lebanon	OHCHR Lebanon	UN OHCHR country profile with reports, treaty status, and recommendations. Critical for UN-level human rights monitoring.
Amnesty International – Lebanon	Amnesty Lebanon	NGO reports covering key rights issues including freedom of expression and refugee protection. Useful for independent perspectives.
Human Rights Watch – Lebanon	HRW Lebanon	NGO monitoring and reporting on Lebanon's human rights issues, offering critical analysis.
UNHCR Lebanon – Refugee Protection	UNHCR Lebanon	Focuses on refugee issues, especially Syrian refugees in Lebanon, essential for UNHRC refugee-related matters.
Lebanese Transparency Association	Transparency Lebanon	Focuses on corruption and governance, linking to human rights and rule of law issues.
Freedom House – Lebanon	Freedom House Lebanon	Annual reports rating Lebanon on political rights and civil liberties, helpful for comparative assessment.
Lebanon Crisis Response Plan (UN OCHA)	Lebanon Crisis Plan	UN humanitarian and rights-focused response plans, useful for crisis-related rights info.

Unique Aspects of Lebanon in the UNHRC Context

1. **Complex Multi-Confessional Society:** Lebanon's rich tapestry of religious and ethnic backgrounds brings about distinct human rights challenges, calling for thoughtful and nuanced discussions within the UNHRC.
2. **Hosting Large Refugee Populations:** Lebanon is home to more than a million Syrian refugees, which makes advocating for refugee rights a key priority in its interactions with the UN Human Rights Council.
3. **Fragile Political Environment:** Political instability continues to affect governance and the enforcement of rights, a concern that often comes up at the UN Human Rights Council.
4. **Post-Conflict Human Rights Issues:** The legacy of civil wars and ongoing conflicts continues to shape Lebanon's human rights issues, particularly when it comes to topics of transitional justice at the UNHRC.
5. **Active Civil Society Despite Constraints:** Lebanese NGOs play a crucial role in advocating for human rights, even in the face of legal and political challenges. Their efforts significantly shape the discussions at the UN Human Rights Council.
6. **Judicial Independence Concerns:** The challenges surrounding judicial independence play a crucial role in Lebanon's human rights reports and the conversations happening at the UN Human Rights Council.
7. **Women's Rights Movement:** Lebanon boasts a dynamic women's rights movement that's actively advocating for legal reforms, frequently highlighted in discussions at the UN Human Rights Council focused on gender issues.
8. **Freedom of Expression Challenges:** Press freedom and the right to express oneself encounter significant challenges, which are frequently highlighted in reviews and reports from the UN Human Rights Council.
9. **Corruption and Governance Issues:** Corruption has a significant impact on the protection of rights and the quality of public services, which is a consistent issue highlighted in Lebanon's assessments by the UN Human Rights Council.
10. **Strong Regional and International Diplomacy:** Lebanon makes the most of its unique geopolitical position to actively participate in UNHRC diplomacy, skillfully balancing the pressures of the region with its commitments to human rights.

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